

The man who discovered how UFOs are powered.

THE WIZARD OF ELECTRO-GRAVITY

By William L. Moore

The most illuminating insight into how UFO's are powered can be found in the life and work of an obscure but brilliant American scientist and inventor, Thomas Townsend Brown. Born into a prominent Zanesville, Ohio family in 1905, Brown displayed early in life an interest in space travel—a subject considered sheer fantasy in the days when there were still those who looked askance at the Wright Brothers' flying machines. Nonetheless, young Brown was not so easily dissuaded, and enjoyed dabbling with what was then regarded as "modern" electronics. It was his youthful toying with the then infant ideas of radio and electromagnetism that provided a background which was to be invaluable to him in later years; and it was during the course of this experimenting that Brown somehow acquired a Coolidge X-ray tube—an item that was to lead him to make a startling discovery.

X-rays (or Röntgen Rays) were indeed mysterious forces in those days (in fact, American physical chemist William D. Coolidge had only just invented the "Coolidge tube" itself in 1913), and even legitimate science was only beginning to learn anything about them. Brown wasn't interested in the X-rays per se, however. Somewhere in his head rested the idea that maybe a key to space flight might be found here; and toward that end, he set up an experiment to determine whether there might be a useful force of some sort exerted by the X-rays emanating from his Coolidge tube.

Trying something that no other scientist of his day had thought of,

Brown mounted his tube in extremely delicate balance and began "testing" for results. To his disappointment, he was unable to detect any measurable force exerted by the rays regardless of which way he turned his apparatus; but to his amazement, he did note a very strange quality of the Coolidge tube itself: Every time it was turned on, the tube seemed to exhibit a motion of its own—a "thrust" of some sort, as if the apparatus was trying to move! Investigating further, Brown had to spend considerable time and effort before the truth finally dawned: The X-rays had nothing whatsoever to do with this new-found phenomenon—it was the high voltage used to produce the rays which was behind it!

Brown now began a series of experiments designed to determine the nature of the "force" he had discovered, and after much effort finally succeeded in developing a device which he optimistically called a "Gravitor". His invention looked like nothing more than a bakelite case some twelve inches long and four inches square, but when placed on a scale and connected to a one hundred kilovolt power source, the apparatus proceeded to gain or lose about one percent of its weight (depending on polarity). Brown was sure he had discovered a new electrical principle, but he remained unsure of just what to do with it. And in spite of the fact that there were a few newspaper accounts of his work, no scientist of any stature expressed an interest in his discovery—a not entirely surprising reaction when one considers that Brown was only then about to graduate from high school!

Readily recognizing his youth as a

handicap, Brown elected to "proceed with caution," and in 1922 he entered the California Institute of Technology (Caltech) at Pasadena, Ca. as a "promising young freshman," and spent his first year courting the favor of his professors—among them the late physicist and Nobel laureate Dr. Robert A. Millikan. His success in being able to convince his instructors of his excellence as a lab man was offset by his complete inability to gain even the slightest measure of recognition for his ideas about electro-gravity. His teachers, steeped to the last in the rigors of 19th century scientific discipline, steadfastly refused to admit that such a thing could exist, and hence, "weren't interested."

Undaunted, Brown transferred nearer to home to Kenyon College (Gambier, Ohio) in 1923, remaining there only a year and then transferring to Denison University at Granville, Ohio, where he studied as an electronics resident in the Department of Physics under Dr. Paul Alfred Biefeld, professor of physics and astronomy and former classmate, in Switzerland, of Dr. Albert Einstein.

Unlike Dr. Millikan at Caltech, Dr. Biefeld proved to be interested in Brown's discovery, and together the two of them, professor and student, experimenting with charged electrical capacitors, developed a principle of physics which came to be tentatively known as the "Biefeld-Brown Effect." Basically, the "effect" concerned the observed tendency of a highly charged electrical condenser to exhibit motion toward its positive pole—the same motion observed earlier by Brown with his Coolidge tube.

Following the completion of his formal education, Townsend Brown joined the staff of the Swazey Observatory in Ohio, where he

remained for some four years and during which time he married. Opportunity came searching in 1930, and Brown left the staff of Swazey to sign on with the Naval Research Laboratory in Washington, D.C., as a specialist in radiation, field physics and spectroscopy.

It was during this phase of his life that he participated, as staff physicist, in the Navy Department's International Gravity Expedition to the West Indies in 1932, and as physicist in the Johnson-Smithsonian Deep Sea Expedition of 1933. Later that same year, the Depression took its toll and budget cutbacks forced him to leave the Naval Research Lab in search of "greener pastures." Undaunted, he joined the U.S. Naval Reserve, and, finding scientific jobs scarce, landed a position first as a soil engineer for the Federal Emergency Relief Administration and later as an administrator for the Civilian Conservation Corps in Ohio.

Daytime jobs during the thirties; however, did not prevent Brown from continuing his studies of physics in general and the Biefeld-Brown effect in particular during available evening and weekend hours; and with the passage of time, the original "Gravitor" design saw numerous improvements.

In 1939, Brown, now a lieutenant in the naval reserve, went to Maryland as a material engineer for the Glenn L. Martin Company of Baltimore (later Martin Aerospace), but was there only a matter of months when he was called upon by the Navy to become officer in charge of magnetic and acoustic minesweeping research and development under the Bureau of Ships. He served faithfully, presiding over the expenditure of nearly \$50 million for research (there were some fifteen Ph.D.'s responsible to Brown at one point), and even consulting with Einstein himself on occasion (the common bond, remember, was Dr. Biefeld), until after Pearl Harbor when he was transferred, with the rank of lieutenant commander, to Norfolk to continue his research while heading up the Navy's Atlantic Fleet Radar School there.

The early years of the War saw Lieutenant Commander Brown deeply involved as a physicist with projects conducted under the National Defense Research Committee (NDRC), and later under its successor, the Office of Scientific Research headed by Dr. Vannevar Bush. Among other things, Brown performed some very valuable high-vacuum work as well as experiments centered on perfecting methods of ship degaussing. However, the combined effects of his having worked "too long and too hard", and of his personal

disappointment in the failure of his projects to gain proper recognition resulted in a nervous collapse in December of 1943. Retirement from the service quickly followed and Brown was sent home to rest.

Six months later, the spring of 1944 found him working as a radar consultant for the advanced design section of Lockheed-Vega Aircraft Corporation in California. Colleagues referred to him as a "quiet, modest, retiring man . . . a brilliant solver of engineering problems" and "exactly the sort (of man) one expects to find in important research installations." More importantly, he was still working on his Gravitor, although, interestingly, Brown would not speak in terms of gravity when describing it—preferring rather to use the more scientific but decidedly less sensational term "stress in dielectrics."

Things began to look up just a bit in the post-war years. After leaving Lockheed, Brown went to Hawaii to take up private residence and to continue his research. It was during this time, partly through the efforts of an old friend (A.L. Kitzelman) who was then teaching calculus at Pearl Harbor, that Brown's Gravitor device, somewhat improved over earlier editions, came to the interest of none other than Admiral Arthur W. Radford, Commander in Chief of the U.S. Pacific Fleet (later to become Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff under President Eisenhower, 1953-57). As a result of Admiral Radford's interest, Brown was temporarily accorded consultant status to the Pearl Harbor Navy Yard; but in spite of the fact that the former lieutenant commander was well treated by his navy friends, it appears from the evidence that they considered his invention as rather more of an interesting curiosity than any sort of key to space travel. Perhaps, to engage in a bit of speculation, had Brown been more of a salesman than a scientist, things might have been different.

In the meantime, the appearance of UFOs on the American scene at the turn of the decade had succeeded in capturing Brown's personal interest. Eagerly following the controversy as it raged among the military and scientific community in the late forties and early fifties, Brown postulated that perhaps with the proper worldwide scientific approach, question of how UFOs are powered might be solved. In those days, his belief in the abilities of modern science was such that he even dared to speculate on the possibility of a quick solution, given the proper resources and manpower, and, of course, he remained constantly aware of the possibility that he had, through his own

efforts at research into electro-gravity, hit upon one of the keys to the mystery.

Moving to Cleveland in 1952, Brown conceived of a project he called "Winterhaven," an idea which he hoped, with proper refinements, could be offered for sale to the military establishment. Through patient research, he succeeded in improving the lift-force of his Gravitor apparatus until it was such that it could lift significantly in excess of one hundred per-cent of its own weight—a success that should have raised the eyebrows of any respectable scientist or pentagon official—but apparently didn't, even though the apparatus involved was quite sophisticated and, as we shall see, the demonstrations most impressive.

According to modern science, everything in the known universe owes its existence to three basic energies or forces: electromagnetism, nuclear forces, and gravity. Whether these three are separate forces, or whether they are each manifestations of some more basic unifying force is still a matter of scientific conjecture. Indeed, Albert Einstein's life work was largely devoted to trying to perfect a theory of Unified Field, and in the process of trying to derive the field equations involved, came to speculate that what we call "matter" is, in reality, only a local phenomenon exhibited by areas of extreme field-energy concentration. Even establishment science does not question the patently obvious relationship between electricity and magnetism, but the relationship of these two fields to the "gravity field" constitutes an area of physics which, more than twenty years after Einstein's death, is still largely incomprehensible to modern science. In general, most of orthodox science in the seventies does tend to recognize a loose linking or "coupling" effect of some sort between electrical and gravitational forces, but precious few scientists have seen fit to speculate that this coupling effect might be at all applicable. At least, such is the case officially, although there exists sufficient reason to suspect that there may have been significant advancements in this area which are still well hidden under that proverbial "brass lid" emblazoned with the phrase "Top Secret."

In any event, Townsend Brown's departure from orthodoxy rests on the above point. Brown firmly believes there is a linking force between gravity and electricity. Whether there may be a further connection between magnetism and gravity, and hence a "unifying" field relationship between all three is yet another question. But to get back to basics; Townsend Brown believes—and his experiments seem to bear him

out—that the Biefeld-Brown Effect manifests a proven link between electricity and gravity.

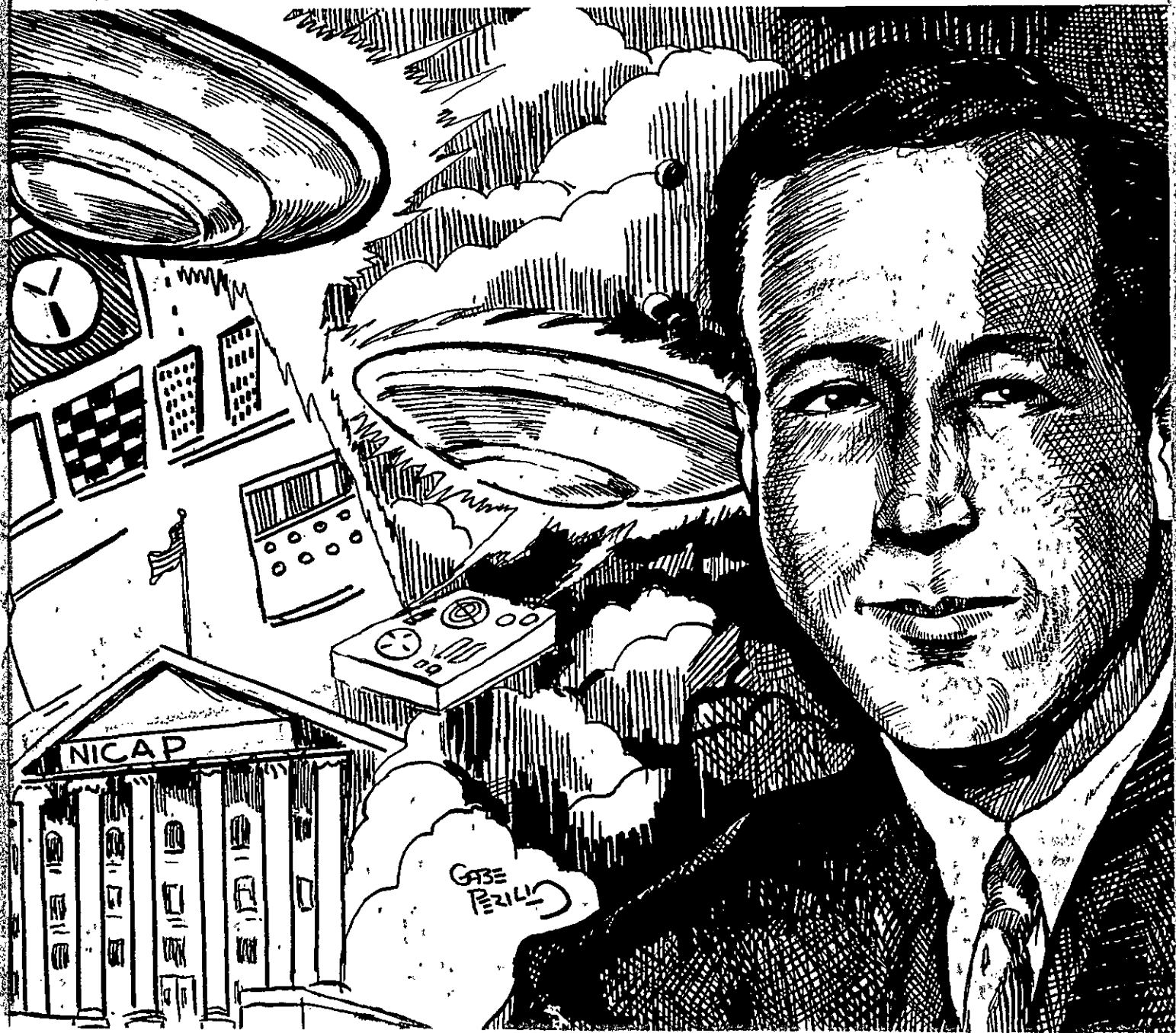
A "dielectric" is defined as a material which has the unique ability of absorbing electrical energy or "charge" without ordinarily passing this energy on to neighboring materials. Some dielectrics are able to absorb enormous quantities of electrical energy (also referred to as "elastic stress") without discharging, providing that the energy is fed into the dielectric slowly and at low potential. Still others can be charged and discharged at extremely high potential at a rate equal to several thousand times each second. Townsend Brown concerned himself principally with this latter type. Using just such a dielectric,

Brown constructed disc (or saucer) shaped condensers, and, by applying various amounts of high-voltage direct current, witnessed the Biefeld-Brown effect in action. With the proper construction and electrical potential (in the kilovolt range) the disc-shaped "air foils" were made to fly under their own power, emitting a slight hum and a bluish electrical glow as they did so. More scientifically, perhaps, this process of "flight" might best be described as "motion under the influence of interaction between electrical and gravitational fields in the direction of the positive electrode."

In 1953, Brown succeeded in demonstrating, in his laboratories, the flight of disc-shaped air foils two feet in diameter around a circular course twenty feet in diameter. The process

involved tethering these saucer-shaped craft to a central pole by means of a wire through which the necessary D.C. electrical potential was supplied at a rate of fifty thousand volts with a continuous input of fifty watts. The test produced an observable top speed of an amazing seventeen feet per-second (11½ miles per hour).

Working with almost superhuman determination and at great cost to his personal finances, Brown soon succeeded in surpassing even this accomplishment. At his next display, he exhibited a set of discs three feet across flying a fifty foot diameter course with results so spectacular that they were immediately classified. Even so, CONTINUED ON PAGE 54



CONTINUED FROM PAGE 52

The star's entire energy output, that would otherwise have lasted for many millions of years, would be expended in a few days. The supernova could be used as a quarry in which heavy elements could be mined. The difficulties do not seem insurmountable. Burbidge has calculated that to cause such a stellar explosion the laser beam would have to deploy energy of one trillion kilowatts—which is only 1,000 times greater than the total power consumption of our present Phase I civilization.

Burbidge has worked out the details of this plan. The beam would operate at gamma ray frequencies, with wavelengths of about 1 Angstrom unit (one 10-billionth of a meter). The beam

width at the point of firing would be a tiny fraction of a second of arc. This would insure that if the target star was 10 light-years distant, the beam on the star's surface would cover an area about six miles wide. Armed with its trillion kilowatts, the beam would generate energy at about 10 billion ergs per square centimeter each second. A nuclear chain reaction would convulse the whole star, and a colossal explosion would follow.

Gradually, by processes ever more ambitious and elaborate, the entire Galaxy of 100 billion stars could be "tamed" and tapped for their energy, matter and living space. "If we assume a technology with a strong drive to expand," Dyson explains, "it will move from star to star in times, at most, of

the order of 1,000 years. It will spread from one end of a galaxy to another in 10 million years—which is still a short time by astronomical standards."

A "tame" galaxy would look quite different from the outside than a "wild" one he argued. "Starlight, instead of shining wastefully, would be carefully dammed and regulated. Stars, instead of moving at random, would be grouped and organized." From this he concludes that no advanced Phase 3 civilization has yet taken over any visible parts of our own Galaxy. But other galaxies in the universe number, at a conservative minimum, some 15 billion; and so the fact that our Galaxy seems to be still "wild" proves very little about the possible existence of super-advanced Phase 3 civilizations. ★

ELECTRO-GRAVITY

(Continued from page 51)

most scientists who witnessed the demonstrations remained skeptical and generally attributed Brown's motive force to what they called an "electrical wind," in spite of the fact that a veritable "electrical hurricane" would have to be involved to produce the lift-potential observed. Pitiful few gave any credence whatsoever to the idea that the Biefeld-Brown Effect might represent anything new in the world of physics. Government funds were sought to enable the work to continue, but in 1955, seeing that the money was not forthcoming, a disgruntled Brown went to Europe in hopes that perhaps he might be able to generate a little more enthusiasm on the continent.

Demonstrations were given first in England, but it was on the mainland under the auspices of a French corporation, La Société Nationale de Construction Aeronautique Sud Ouest (SNCASO), that things really began to look promising. During a set of tests performed confidentially within the company's research laboratory, Brown succeeded in flying some of his discs in a high vacuum with amazing results, thereby proving that, in fact, his discs flew more efficiently without air. Also proven during this series of experiments was that the speed and efficiency of the "craft" could be increased by providing greater voltage to the dielectric plates. Contemporary accounts easily visualized speeds of several hundred miles-per-hour using voltages in the range of one to two hundred thousand electron volts, and at least one writer spoke of a "flame jet generator" then in the planning stage, which supposedly would be able to provide power potential up to 15 million volts! In fact, plans had been laid for the immediate construction of a large vac-

uum chamber and a one-half million volt power supply when disaster struck the project in the form of a corporate merger. SNCASO had agreed to combine with a larger company to form what was termed a "Super Douglass of France": Sud Est. The president of the emerging company proceeded to demonstrate an appalling lack of interest in "these far-out propulsion research efforts" and favored instead an increased interest in "air frame manufacture." All facilities designated and created by the former president to carry on the work on electro-gravity were summarily cancelled and a thoroughly disappointed Brown was forced to return home to the U.S. in 1956.

The summer of that year found him living in the Washington, D.C., area still interested in UFO research and hoping fervently that if scientific evidence could be uncovered suggesting their possible method of propulsion, his own work would be greatly enhanced—an idea which leads us down yet another avenue of Townsend Brown's life.

The key to this phase was a then-67-year-old widow named Mrs. Walton C. John—better known as "Clara" to her friends. Clara John was the occasional publisher of a mimeographed tract known as *The Little Listening Post* which dealt with a variety of novel and esoteric items, not the least of which was the UFO. In the course of her excursions into the netherworld of the bizarre and the novel, she had come into contact with Townsend Brown, and by 1955 had managed to maintain an intermittent correspondence with him for several years.

Clara John, however, was far too active a personality to satisfy her interests through mere correspondence. In the spring of 1956, Mrs. John had enthusiastically organized a small circle of friends and acquaintances, all of whom shared a common interest in the

UFO, into what came to be called "The Flying Saucer Discussion Group"—an informal collection of the curious and interested which met on a more-or-less monthly basis at the Y.W.C.A. and invited well known figures in the UFO field to speak. Not surprisingly, one of the interested who sat in on occasional meetings was Townsend Brown. His interest stemmed from the fact that he felt, as he put it, "if we could maintain surveillance with a nationwide or worldwide reporting service, we might arrive more quickly at a scientific explanation of (their) method of propulsion, based on light emission and performance patterns."

Developments were not long in forthcoming. In July, the Discussion Group arranged for local UFO expert and author Morris K. Jessup to address their next meeting. In a note to Brown about the meeting, Mrs. John remarked that "another thing one keeps hearing mentioned is the idea of some central research organization or 'Foundation' probably located in Washington, for coordinating this whole UFO study. Mr. Jessup is the third man to have mentioned it to me recently."

"The meeting . . . scheduled for 8 p.m., July 20th, would be the group's fourth session. Jessup, the slated speaker, thought it would be a good time to consider the question of a new UFO organization." Brown, elated the serious support for a worldwide scientific look at the UFO appeared to be rapidly developing, readily offered to draft a preliminary proposal for the next meeting and agreed to look into the possibilities concerning necessary leg and financial support. Mrs. John agreed to spread the word among the faithful.

Barely a month later, what was to become the largest, and for a time the most influential, of the UFO organizations was created: "the National In-

CONTINUED ON PAGE 56

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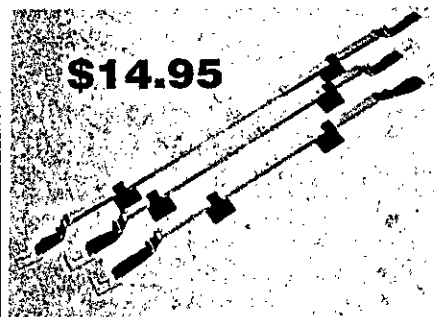


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CONTINUED FROM PAGE 54

tigations Committee on Aerial Phenomena," more commonly referred to as NICAP. On Aug. 29, 1956, a mere two weeks after final endorsement by the Flying Saucer Discussion Group, Townsend Brown filed documents of incorporation for the new organization in the District of Columbia, listing among the Board of Governors two physicists, two ministers, two businessmen, a former rear admiral and a retired army brigadier general. Clara John voiced the hopes of all concerned by stating her expectations that the "floodgates of confusion" in the UFO field had "at last found a safe and orderly outlet."

Through September and October, Brown, in his capacity as director began to set up shop. The new committee, he felt, should be organized along proven corporate lines so as to insure maximum efficiency in all phases of the operation. Accordingly, an acting treasurer was appointed, office space was acquired, and the services of a secretary obtained. At last, with the final approval on Oct. 24, 1956 of NICAP's corporate charter, Brown's dream became reality. It was, for Brown, to be short lived.

From the start, financial problems plagued the organization. Initially, Brown had projected an annual outlay of \$85,000 to cover salaries and expenses, and, in keeping with this figure, had set annual membership dues at \$15.00 for basic membership, and up to \$1000 for founders. As the fates would have it, the expenses materialized soon enough, but the anticipated revenue did not. By year's end, after barely two months of active existence, the Committee was on the verge of bankruptcy.

The showdown came at a climactic meeting of the membership in January, 1957, at which Brown was accused of following an irresponsible fiscal policy, and leading the group on too radical a course. During the shouting match that followed, Brown's anti-gravity theories were repeatedly referred to amidst allegations that Brown's sole purpose in organizing the group was to further his own research. Faced with bankruptcy or reorganization, the Board of Governors forced Brown's resignation the next day and appointed former Marine Major Donald E. Keyhoe, noted UFO author and investigator, as the new director with virtually unlimited powers.

Keyhoe proved a capable director, but his philosophies as to the direction NICAP should take in attacking the mysteries of the UFO proved markedly different from Brown's envisioned objectives. As a result, Keyhoe's charted course over the next thirteen years was

CONTINUED ON PAGE 58

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CONTINUED FROM PAGE 56

to lead more often to the halls of Congress than to the domains of science. Brown's vision of "a quick scientific solution" became mired in a sea of politics which was to last until Keyhoe's retirement in 1969.

The loss of the helm following the January confrontation was, at the very least, a severe blow to Brown's hopes for Winterhaven—but the work went on. Within a year, he was busily engaged as chief research and development consultant for the Whitehall-Rand Project, a new anti-gravity venture being conducted under the personal auspices of Agnew Bahnson, president of the Bahnson Company of Winston-Salem, North Carolina. Bahnson was something of a flying saucer buff who nurtured a personal desire to be the first man to set foot on the moon. Using personal funds, he constructed a well-equipped private laboratory and invited Brown to come down and consult with him. But, as fate would have it, just as things began to look good for the venture, Mr. Bahnson was killed when his private airplane struck a high tension wire. The project quickly suffered a similar fate at the hands of thoroughly disinterested heirs.

In 1958, believing he had finally generated enough momentum to "go it alone," Townsend Brown organized his own corporation under the name of Rand International Limited, and set himself up as president. Although numerous patents were applied for and granted both in the U.S. and abroad, and in spite of many patiently given demonstrations to interested governmental and corporate groups, success again eluded him.

In the early sixties, Brown did a brief stint as physicist for Electrokinetics

Inc., of Bala Cynwyd, Pa. and upon terminating his employment there, went into semi-retirement. Since then, he has lived on in California, quietly pursuing his research in hopes that perhaps someday, with a little luck, the world will notice.

His most recent involvement is with a project housed largely at Stanford Research Institute with additional assistance being provided by the University of California and the Ames Research Center of NASA. The object of the research, details of which are still largely under wraps, is to try to determine what connection there is, if any, between the earth's gravitational field and rock electricity (petroelectricity). If Brown can achieve his hoped for goal of proving that petroelectricity is "induced" by the earth's gravitational field, it would go a long way toward strengthening not only unified field concepts in general, but Brown's own personal theories on electro-gravity as well.

Which, of course, leads us to the prime question of this article: Why indeed has Townsend Brown's impressive life's work gone so seemingly unnoticed for the past three decades? Even today, Brown is still of the opinion that further research into the Biefeld-Brown Effect could lead to a sensational breakthrough in space propulsion methods, not to mention the more domestic variety—if appropriate funding could be made available. Granted, research is expensive, but—is money the real reason for the apparent lack of interest? Perhaps. Or maybe, as Brown himself suggests, the human race is not yet ready to accept a scientific breakthrough that could place man within reach of the stars. ★

UFO BASE

(Continued from page 47)

Martha is convinced that the occupants of UFOs have been keeping tabs on her over the years, and that at times they may even be reading her mind. After she got married and had children of her own, Martha claims UFOs would often pace her automobile in the late afternoon and evening hours as she returned home from the grocery store or post office.

Several of Martha's sightings have been of a routine nature—lights in the sky—while others have been quite spectacular. On numerous occasions she's seen them hovering just above the ground. One place where she's ob-

served UFOs is over a rock and gravel quarry located less than five miles from Martha's home. "It was during the winter of 1967," she states. "I was at home at eight p.m., when an uncontrollable urge came over me to hop into the car and take a ride. I proceeded toward Route 50, planning to stop to get a pack of cigarettes at a local store that was open late. Instead, I turned left—to this day I don't know why—and continued driving for approximately two miles, until I noticed three bright lights which kind of resembled arc lights, the type they use to light up a baseball field at night."

As she drove along, Martha began to realize that the road was totally deserted. "Usually you see one or two cars going in either direction. This evening, however, nobody was out." Little by little the lights continued to grow in

CONTINUED ON PAGE 60